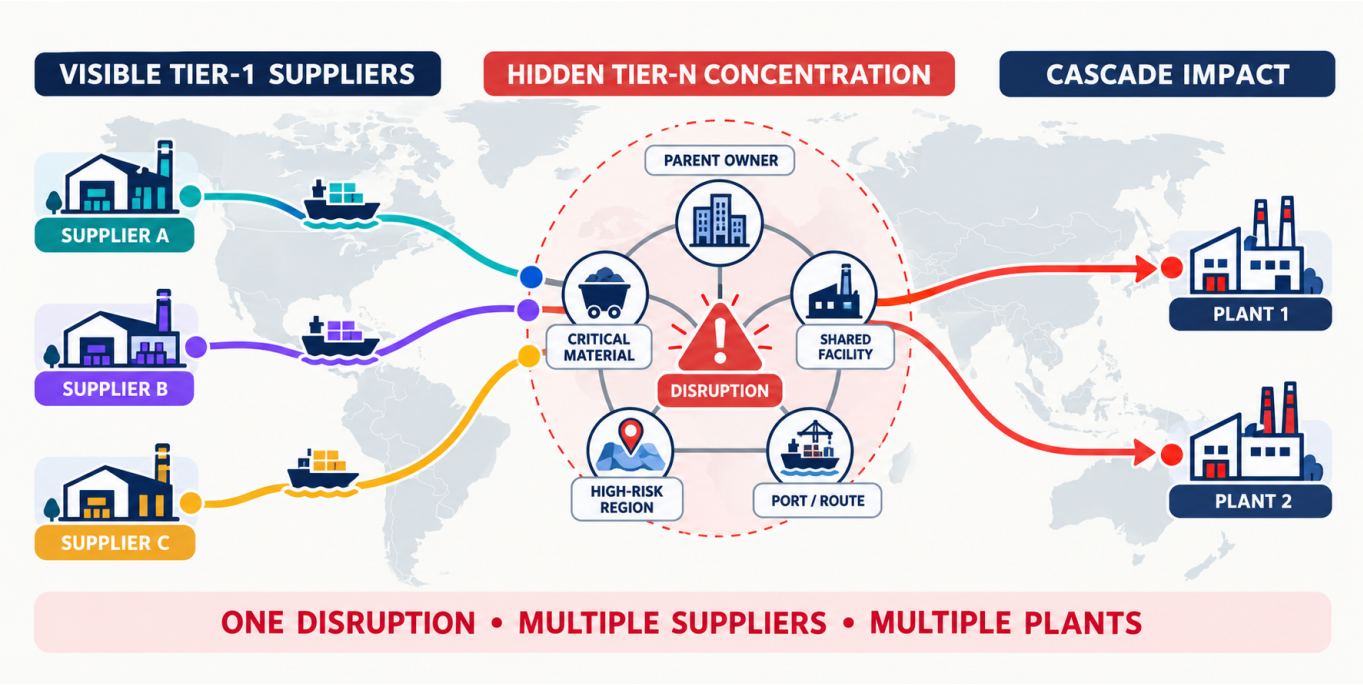
Substrata: A-Z Project Revision Guide

Evidence -> Runway -> Governed Action

One-sentence pitch

Substrata reveals hidden shared Tier-N dependencies, shows how long production remains protected, and keeps every high-impact response evidence-backed, deterministic, and human-approved.



Use this guide in three passes: 1) pages 1-5 for the pitch story, 2) pages 6-13 for technical defence, and 3) pages 14-15 for rapid judge-question rehearsal.

- **Current:** working local synthetic vertical slice with graph discovery, replay, deterministic impact, dry-run approval, and audit.
- **Planned:** LangGraph orchestration, LangChain-grounded domain assistant, Google Gen AI SDK adapter, and optional verified SAP boundary.
- **Never claim:** live customer accuracy, live SAP access, autonomous purchasing, or that 10/10 replay consistency means prediction accuracy.

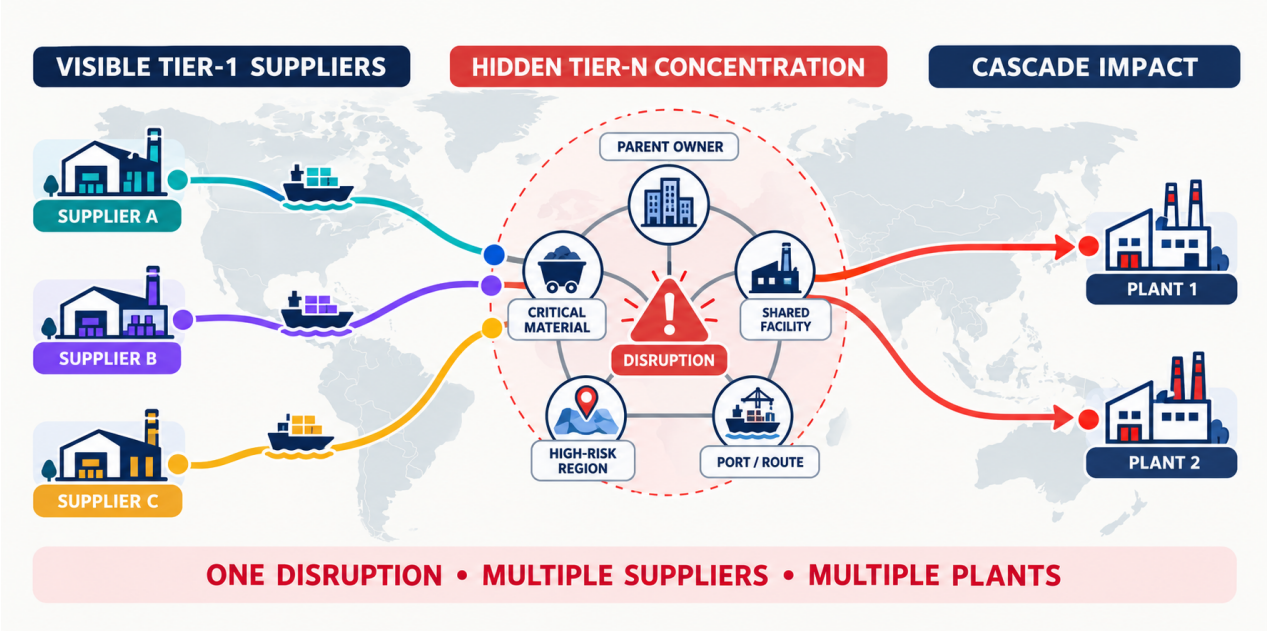
A-Z mental model

- **A** **Audit:** Hash-linked record of evidence, versions, approver, reason, and result.
- **B** **BOM:** Where-used structure connecting materials and components to products and plants.
- **C** **Candidate link:** Evidence-backed relationship proposal; never automatically true.
- **D** **Decision runway:** Time between stock-cover exhaustion and alternative readiness.
- **E** **Evidence:** Exact cited passage or structured record supporting a claim.
- **F** **False diversification:** Several Tier-1 suppliers secretly share an upstream dependency.
- **G** **GraphStore:** Versioned graph interface used for transparent traversal and evidence paths.
- **H** **Human gate:** Named approver accepts or rejects a consequential dry-run action.
- **I** **Inferred:** Unconfirmed relationship state that remains visibly uncertain.
- **J** **JSON contract:** Schema-constrained model output checked before use.
- **K** **Known:** Directly supported information, separated from inferred and unknown.
- **L** **LangGraph:** Selected next-step orchestrator; coordinates tools but does not do math.
- **M** **Mapper:** Proposes cited hidden relationships from records and evidence.
- **N** **Tier-N:** Any deeper supplier tier beyond the direct Tier-1 relationship.
- **O** **Offline replay:** Seeded local fallback that works without provider or SAP access.
- **P** **Policy:** Deterministic rules for allow, review, block, staleness, and authority.
- **Q** **Qualification time:** Days required before an alternate source can safely supply.
- **R** **Relationship status:** Inferred, confirmed, rejected, expired, or superseded.
- **S** **Sensor:** Classifies a disruption and proposes affected entities.
- **T** **Traceability:** Ability to follow an answer to evidence, versions, math, and approval.
- **U** **Uncertainty:** Explicit confidence, gaps, ranges, and incomplete states.
- **V** **Version pinning:** Calculation and approval refer to an immutable graph/input revision.
- **W** **Warning gained:** Extra decision time versus the same Tier-1-only snapshot.
- **X** **eXecution:** Prototype produces approved dry-run payloads, never real procurement writes.
- **Y** **Yielded control:** AI pauses when evidence, authority, or inputs are insufficient.
- **Z** **Zero hidden claims:** Every material assertion is cited, labelled, calculated, or marked unknown.

1. Problem, theme, and case study

Problem statement

Manufacturers often see direct Tier-1 contracts but not the deeper suppliers, facilities, materials, owners, regions, ports, or routes that those suppliers share. A single disruption can therefore hit several apparently independent paths at once.



Why now

- More than 80% of merchandise trade by volume moves by sea; ports and routes matter, but Substrata is not maritime-only.
- Geopolitical controls, ownership changes, plant incidents, material shortages, and regional shocks can expose shared concentration.
- Fragmented ERP, document, news, and supplier evidence delays action until inventory is already low.

Illustrative Nexperia replay

- Public reporting provides only the disruption context; the supplier graph, stocks, lead times, costs, and actions are synthetic.
- The demo assumes 18 days of cover and 90 days to qualify an alternative, producing a 72-day exposure gap.
- This case makes the idea concrete; the platform remains industry-neutral and supports many dependency types.

Judge-safe sentence

The case study illustrates the decision problem; it does not claim access to a real confidential supplier network or prove real-world accuracy.

2. Users, current gap, value, and business hypothesis

User	Main decision	Information needed	Current pain
Supply-risk analyst	Is the hidden dependency credible and material?	Evidence, path, status, confidence, affected scope	Reconciles fragmented records and explains uncertainty
Supply planner	When will production become exposed?	Inventory, supply, consumption, qualification time, plant	Risk alerts do not become a decision deadline
Procurement approver	Which response is justified and authorized?	Options, assumptions, cost/risk, policy reason	Context is split across analysis and approval tools
Supplier contact	Is the proposed relationship correct?	Narrow claim, source context, deadline, permitted use	Broad questionnaires create effort and confidentiality concern

Current approach

- Tier-1 declarations and questionnaires create only partial visibility.
- Analysts manually reconcile ERP records, documents, news, and calls.
- Static maps age quickly; names and units differ across sources.
- Risk scores often hide the decision deadline and evidence quality.

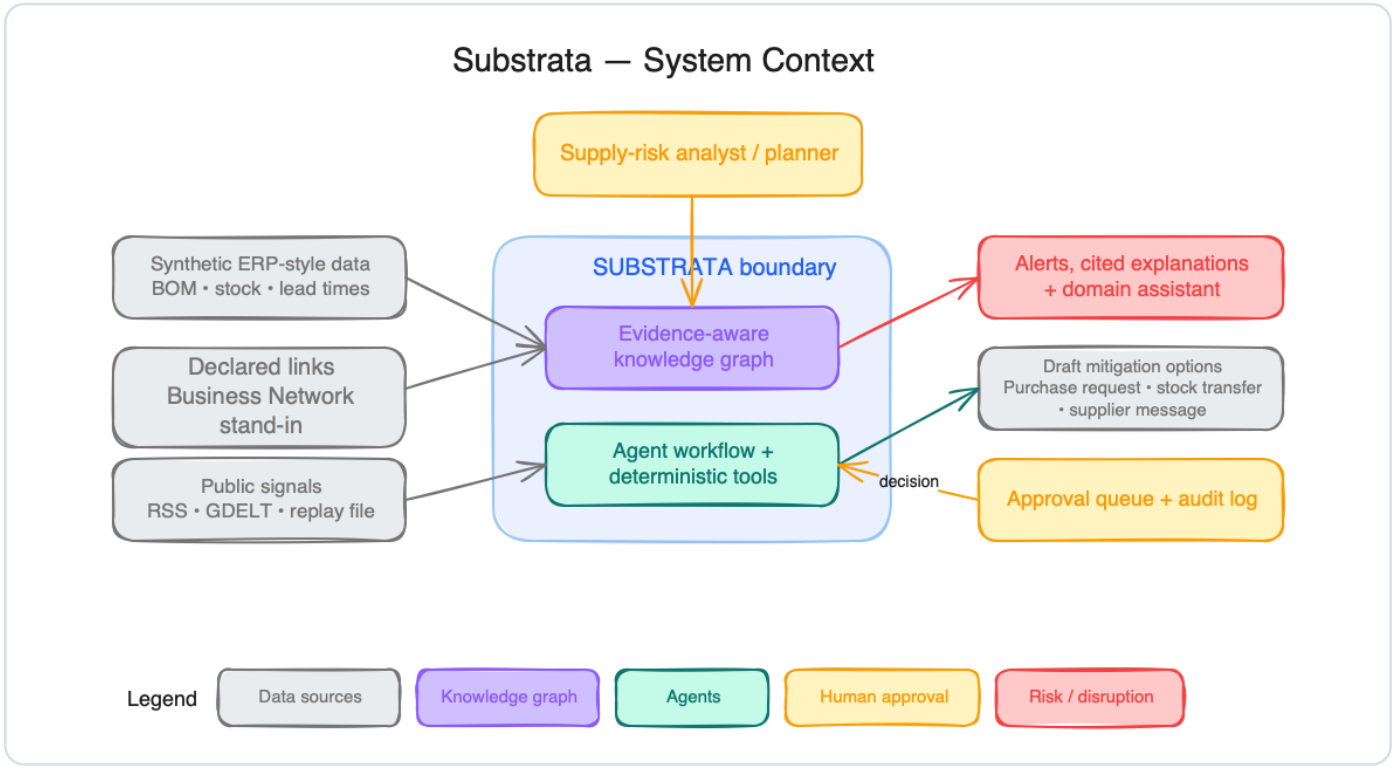
Substrata value

- Evidence-backed candidate links with visible uncertainty.
- Human confirmation before inference becomes accepted truth.
- Deterministic impact and runway instead of vague urgency.
- Governed dry-run actions with named approval and audit.

Business hypothesis - not validated yet

Primary user: supply-risk analyst or planner. Likely buyers: procurement, supply-chain risk, or resilience leadership. Value hypothesis: earlier, more defensible decisions. Interviews must validate willingness to adopt, data-sharing constraints, buying authority, and reviewer workload.

3. End-to-end operating model

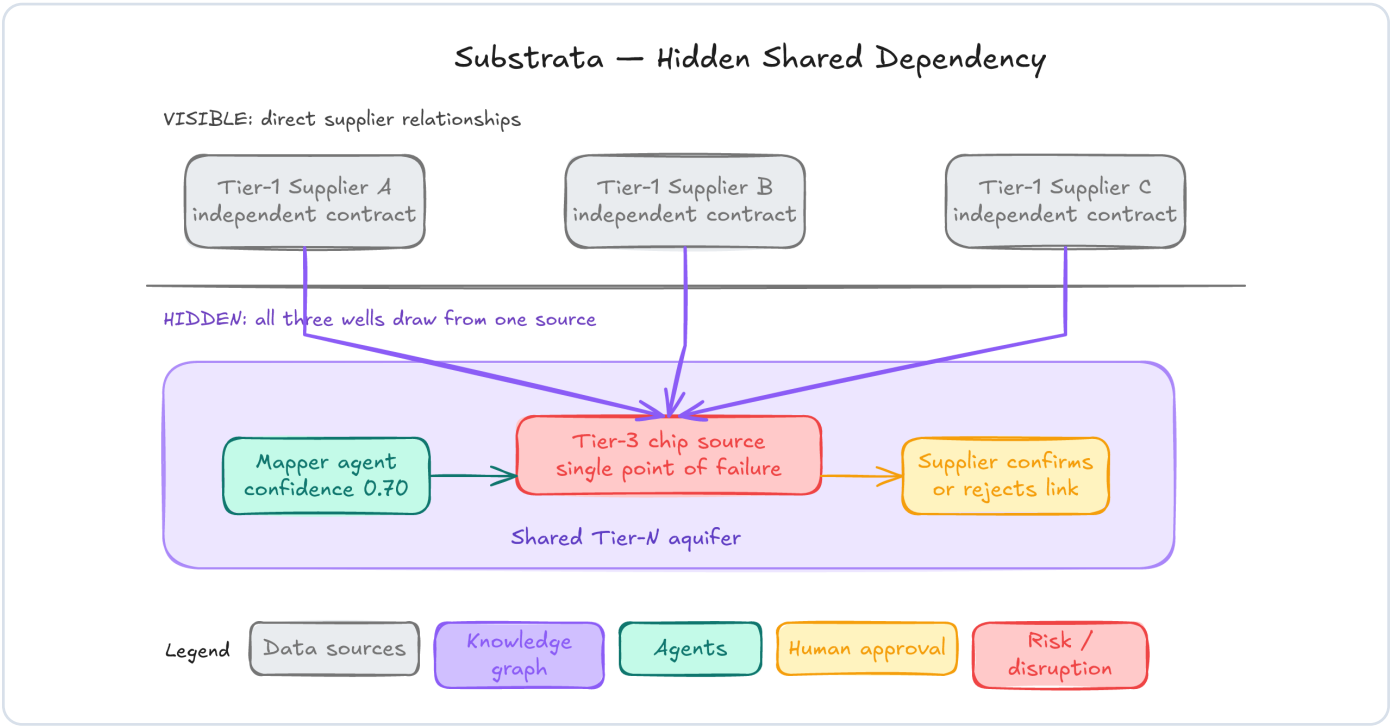


Stage	System responsibility	Human responsibility
1. Ingest	Load ERP-shaped records, documents, declared links, and sourced events	Confirm legal use, source, unit, and freshness
2. Infer	Mapper proposes a structured relationship with exact evidence	Review ambiguity; do not treat confidence as truth
3. Confirm	Store candidate as inferred and send a bounded request	Analyst or supplier confirms, rejects, or lets it expire
4. Sense	Sensor classifies disruption and resolves affected entities	Resolve ambiguous entity or severity matches
5. Calculate	Deterministic engine traverses a pinned graph and calculates runway	Check incomplete inputs, units, and assumptions
6. Act	Action prepares options; policy routes approve/review/block	Named approver accepts or rejects with reason

Core differentiator

Evidence to confirmation, confirmation to runway, and runway to governed action - without allowing uncertain AI output to become supply-chain truth.

4. Evidence, hidden-link discovery, and confirmation



How a candidate link is formed

- Normalize names, sites, identifiers, units, and dates.
- Combine deterministic signals such as exact IDs, BOM references, addresses, ownership, and declared links.
- Use pretrained models only for structured extraction, similarity, and explanation.
- Attach exact evidence spans, source, observation time, model/prompt version, and confidence components.

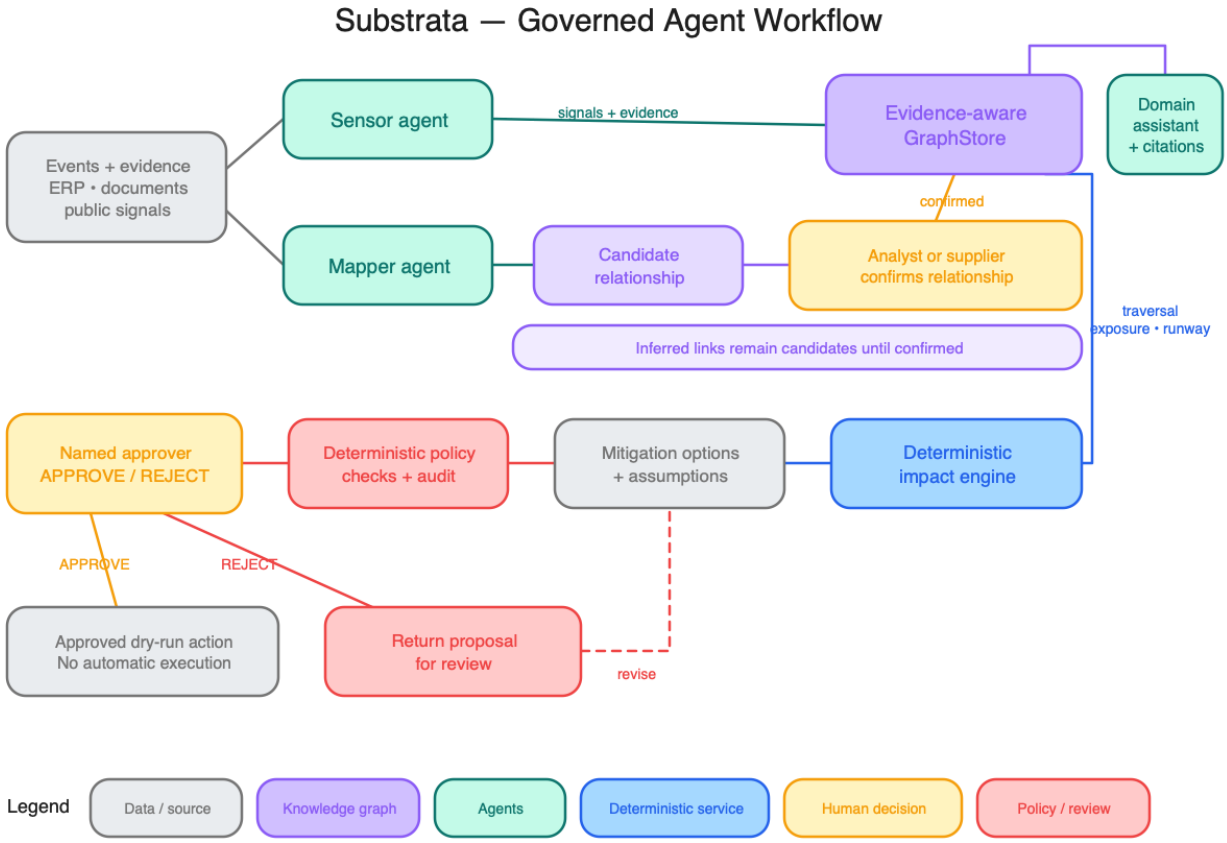
Relationship state machine

- **Inferred:** candidate only; may influence a range but stays visibly uncertain.
- **Confirmed:** accepted by an authorized analyst or supplier response.
- **Rejected:** negative evidence is preserved for review and learning.
- **Expired/superseded:** stale claims never silently remain current.

What link prediction means here

Substrata can predict candidate relationships, but it does not claim a new link-prediction algorithm. The innovation is the operational chain around prediction: cited evidence, bounded confirmation, deterministic impact, decision runway, policy, and audit.

5. What is agentic, and what is not

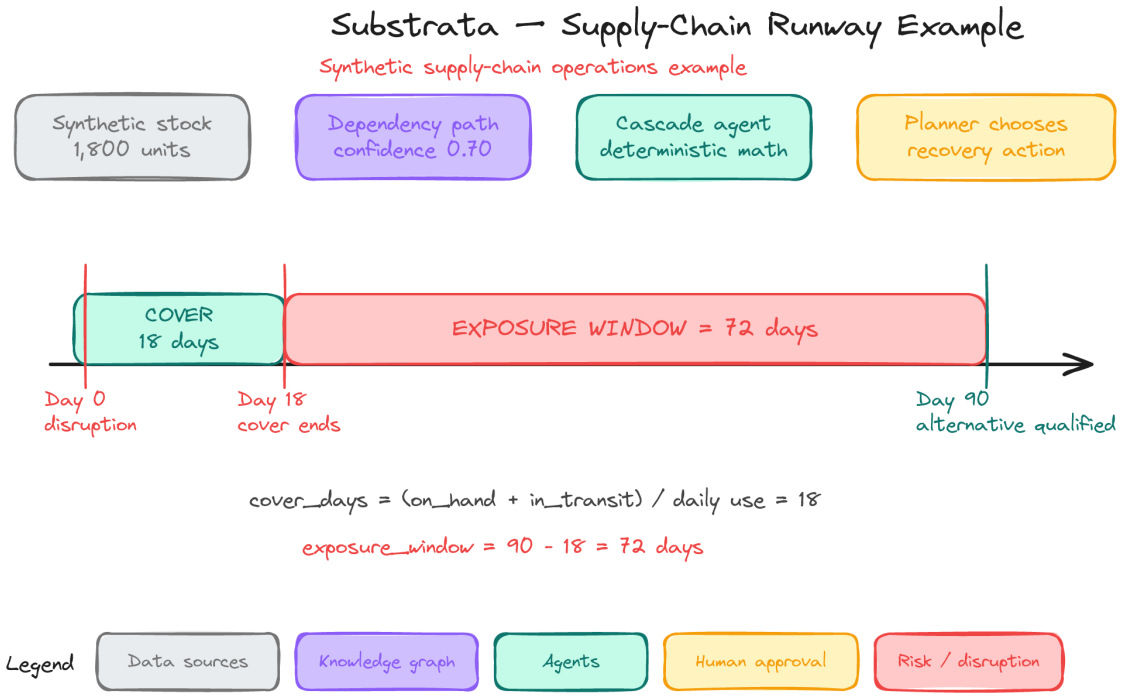


Role	Agentic contribution	Hard boundary
Mapper	Finds and explains evidence-backed candidate links	Cannot confirm a relationship
Sensor	Classifies events and proposes affected entities	Ambiguity goes to review
Domain assistant	Answers path-specific questions with citations and known/inferred/unknown labels	Cannot change graph truth or perform impact math
Action	Prepares and compares mitigation drafts	No real purchasing or shipment execution
Compliance/Audit	Routes policy decisions and records provenance	Rules, versions, and authority are deterministic

LangGraph and LangChain

LangGraph is the selected next-step coordinator for state, tools, pauses, retries, and human gates. LangChain is planned for grounded retrieval and the domain assistant. Neither replaces NetworkX/PostgreSQL calculations, validates relationships automatically, or grants approval.

6. Deterministic impact and decision runway



Synthetic worked example

Available stock = 1,200 units; confirmed incoming supply = 600 units; daily consumption = 100 units. Stock cover = (1,200 + 600) / 100 = 18 days. Alternate qualification = 90 days. Exposure gap = 90 - 18 = 72 days.

Deterministic engine owns

- Version-pinned graph traversal and affected paths.
- BOM where-used, plants, products, and dependency support.
- Unit validation, stock cover, qualification time, ranges, and truncation.
- Policy thresholds, staleness checks, and approval validity.

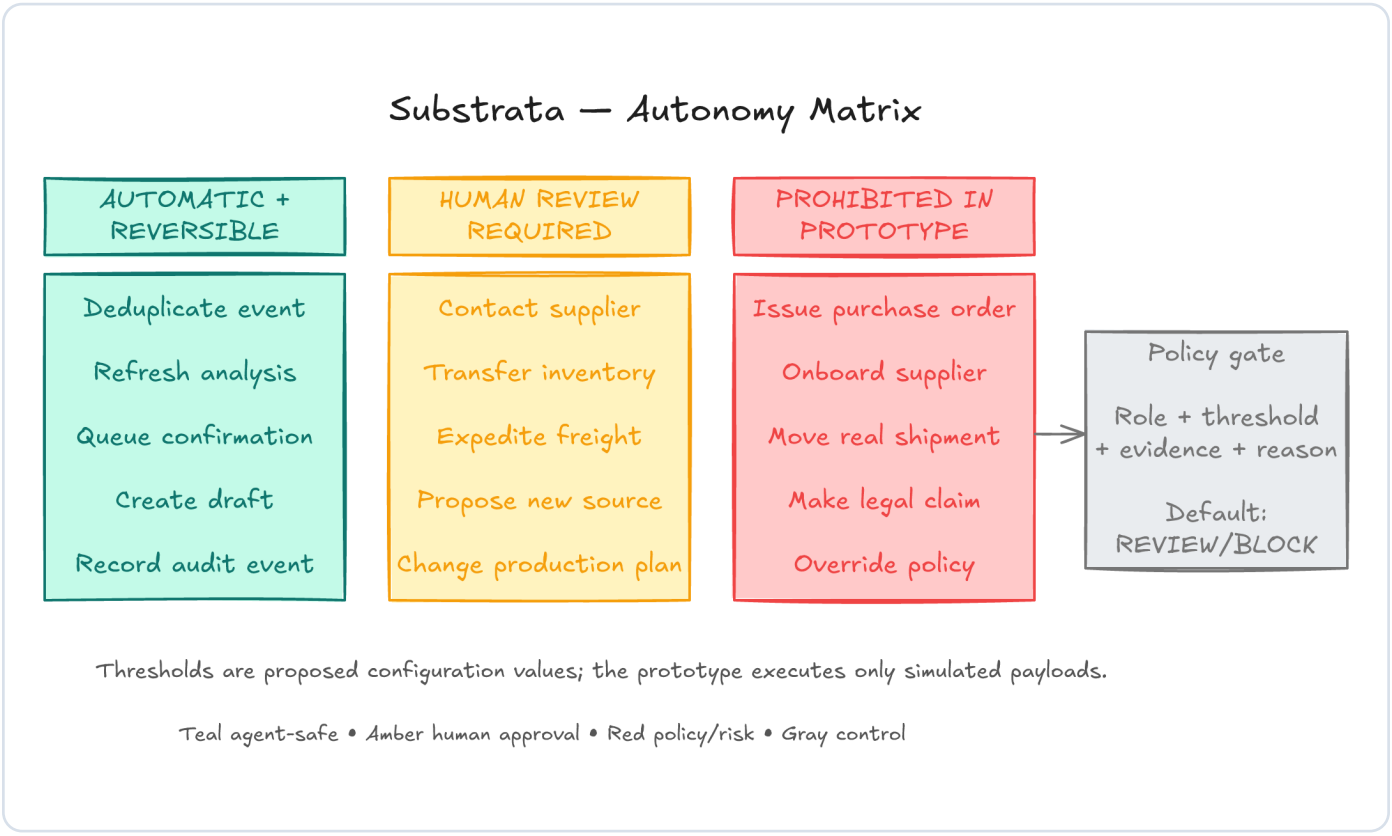
AI may assist with

- Extracting evidence into a strict schema.
- Explaining why a path is relevant.
- Drafting a rationale or supplier message.
- Never inventing quantities, paths, authority, or arithmetic.

Important distinction

The 72-day figure is an operational exposure gap in a synthetic scenario. It is not a project schedule, forecast accuracy claim, or real Nexperia inventory estimate.

7. Governance, safety, privacy, and audit

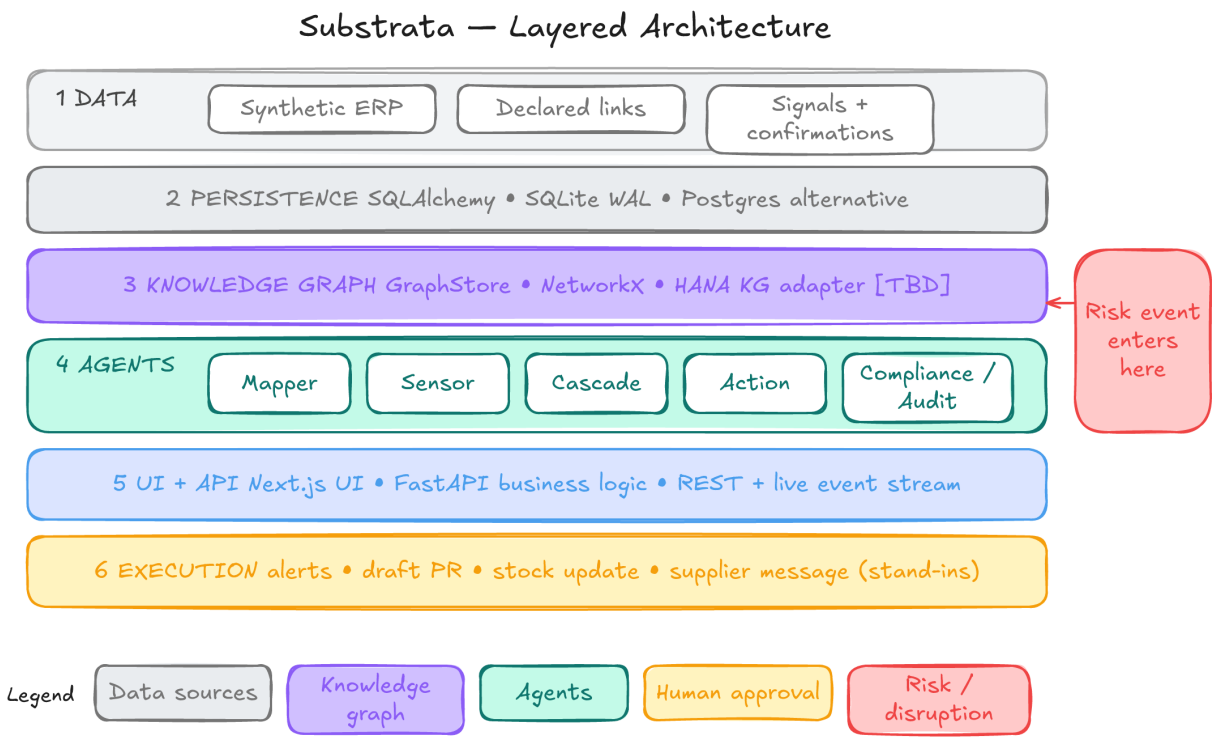


Risk	Control
Incomplete or conflicting Tier-N data	Preserve provenance, show uncertainty, request confirmation
Model hallucination or malformed output	Structured JSON, exact evidence spans, schema validation, review
Confidentiality and source licensing	Tenant isolation, minimum excerpts, access control, approved sources
False urgency from assumptions	Show unit, source, time, range, and incomplete status
Unsafe automation	Real procurement changes prohibited; named approval and dry-run only
SAP/provider unavailable	Core seeded replay stays offline and deterministic

Audit limitation

A SHA-256 chain can reveal later record changes. It does not prove that the original source, inference, or human decision was correct. Truth still depends on evidence quality and authorized confirmation.

8. Architecture, data model, reliability, and security

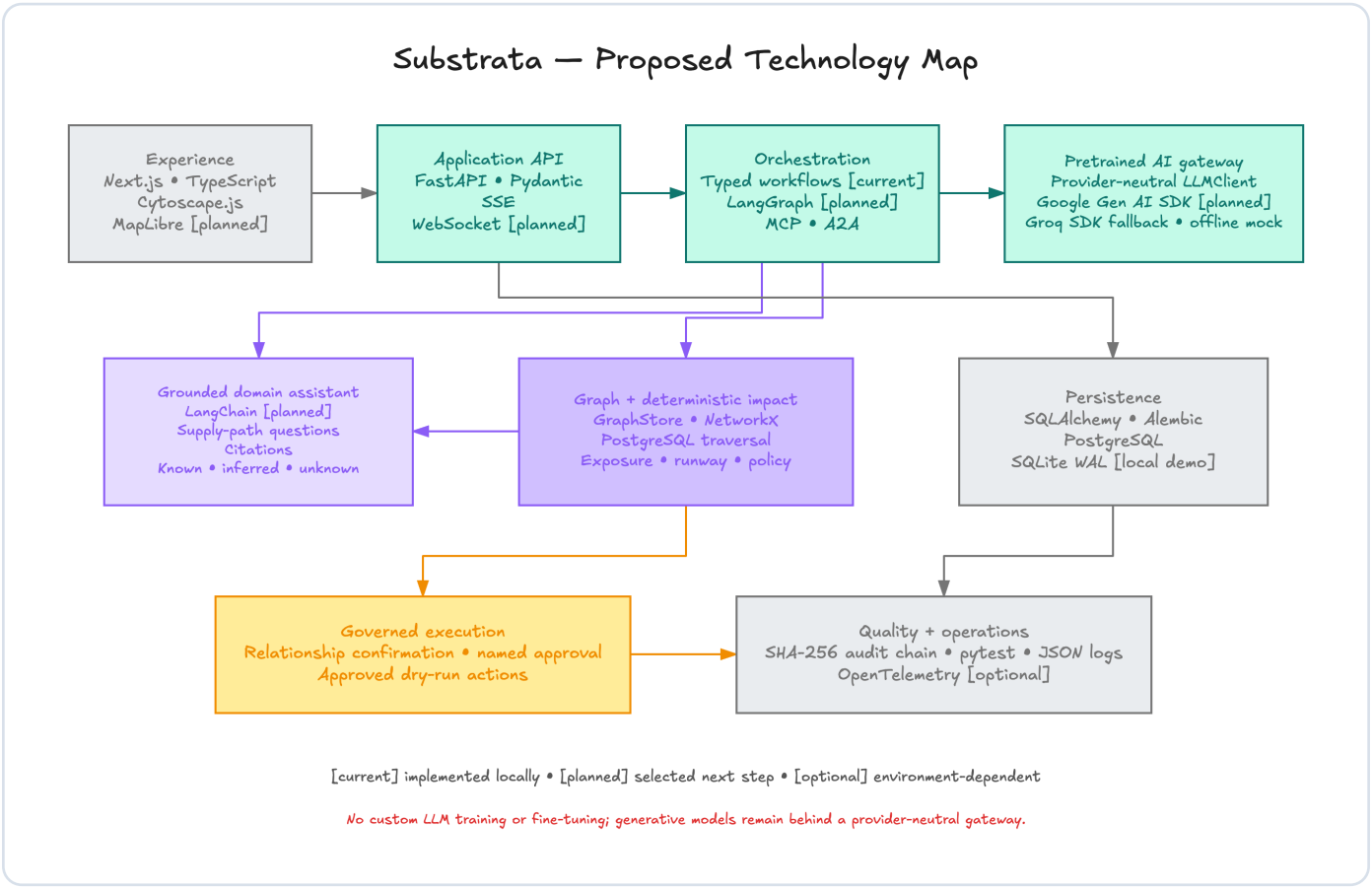


Layer	Key design
Data and provenance	Entities, relationships, evidence, events, scenarios, actions, approvals; each material record is versioned and sourced
Persistence	SQLAlchemy + Alembic; SQLite WAL for local demo; PostgreSQL/pgvector for tenant platform
Graph	GraphStore abstraction; NetworkX and PostgreSQL traversal now; HANA property graph only if entitled
Application	FastAPI/Pydantic owns domain logic; Next.js/TypeScript/Cytoscape renders the workspace; SSE carries updates
Reliability	Seeded fixtures, retries, checkpoints, stale-input rejection, offline provider fallback, and repeatable replay
Security	Tenant isolation, role checks, minimum source excerpts, signed expiring supplier links, bounded requests, and no secrets in logs

Data-model rule

Keep legal entity, supplier site, facility, material, component, product, plant, owner, region, port, and route distinct. Collapsing them creates false paths and misleading impact.

9. Technology map: current, planned, optional

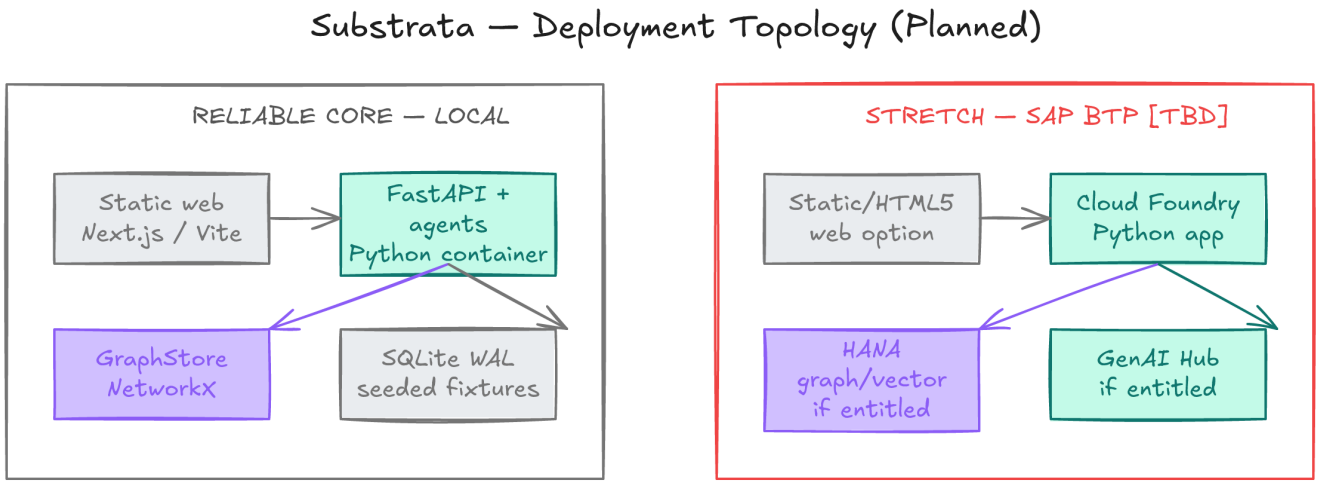


Status	Technology	Purpose
Current	Next.js, TypeScript, Cytoscape.js	Interactive graph and workspace
Current	FastAPI, Pydantic, SSE	Typed API, domain services, live updates
Current	NetworkX, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, SQLite/PostgreSQL	Graph traversal, persistence, migrations
Current	Provider-neutral LLMClient, Gemini/Groq transport, offline mock	Structured extraction and fallback
Planned	LangGraph + LangChain + Google Gen AI SDK	Orchestration, grounded assistant, Gemini adapter
Optional	MCP/A2A, MapLibre, OpenTelemetry	Bounded interoperability, map view, observability
SAP stretch	BTP, Integration Suite, HANA graph/vector, AI Core	Read-only clean-core integration if access exists

Training answer

There is no custom LLM training or fine-tuning. A separate classical gradient-boosted link scorer can learn from reviewed labels under activation gates; it is not the generative model and is not required for the finale proof.

10. SAP alignment and honest integration path

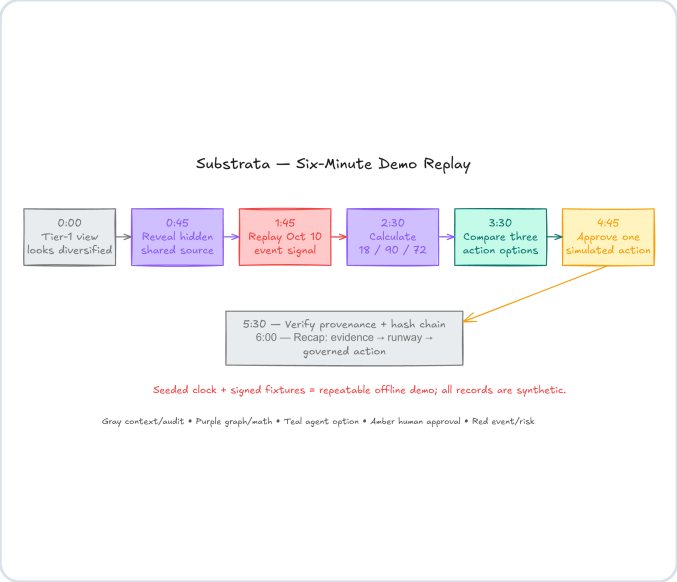


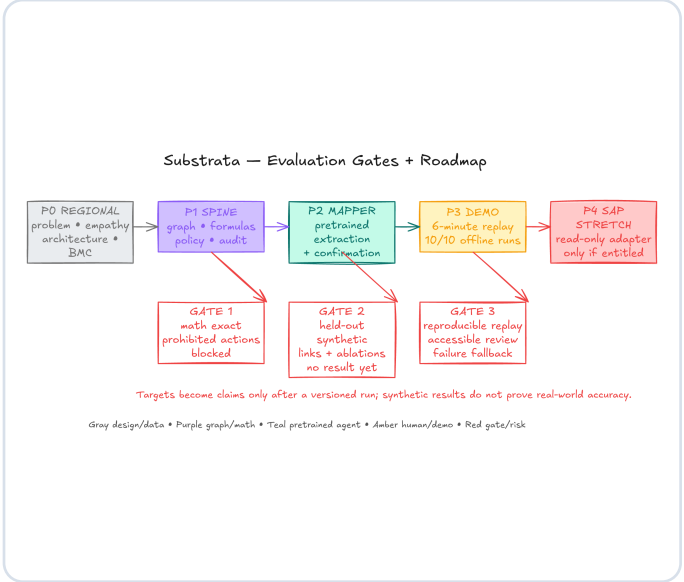
SAP technology/concept	Role in Substrata	Status
SAP S/4HANA released APIs	Read-only procurement, BOM, inventory, and lead-time context	Access-dependent
SAP Business Network / Ariba APIs	Supplier and trading-partner relationships	Access-dependent
SAP BTP + Integration Suite	API-first, side-by-side clean-core extension	Finale stretch
SAP HANA Cloud graph/vector	Dependency traversal and grounded retrieval	Entitlement-dependent
SAP AI Core generative AI hub	Governed pretrained-model adapter	Optional
Joule, MCP, and A2A	User interaction and agent interoperability adapters	Optional

Learning Hub connection

- Purchasing in SAP S/4HANA: procurement master data, sources of supply, and approvals.
- SAP Business Network: supplier collaboration and multi-tier visibility.
- Clean Core: API-first side-by-side extension instead of ERP modification.
- Responsible AI: evidence, uncertainty, human oversight, traceability, and governed automation.

11. Demo, evaluation, feasibility, and roadmap





Measure	Proposed target	Meaning
Hidden-link precision	>= 0.80	Correct candidates at review threshold
Hidden-link recall	>= 0.70	Held-out synthetic links found
Impact fixtures	100% exact	Hand-calculated deterministic cases
Prohibited actions	100% blocked	Policy safety tests
Offline replay	10/10 identical	Reproducibility, not accuracy

Gate	Compact deliverable	Exit condition
Plan	Validate persona, decision, data, uncertainty, SAP access	One practitioner validates workflow and runway
Design	Freeze contracts, boundaries, failure behavior, fixture	Every input, output, assumption, and authority is explainable
Build	Harden orchestration, citations, impact, approval, audit, fallback	Fresh environment runs the complete scenario
Test	Measure links, answers, math, policy, failures, usability	Repeatable demo; every result is traceable

Smallest credible finale proof

Discover one hidden dependency, confirm it, replay one event, calculate runway, compare simulated actions, approve one, and verify the audit chain. Exclude autonomous purchasing, production SAP writes, unbounded crawling, customer-accuracy claims, and a custom GNN.

12. Judge Q&A - problem, user, value, and SAP

Q What exact problem do you solve?
False diversification: Tier-1 suppliers can share a deeper dependency. We surface evidence, quantify runway, and govern response.

Q Who is the primary user?
A supply-risk analyst or planner; procurement approvers and supplier contacts participate at specific gates.

Q Why is this urgent?
A hidden dependency can affect multiple paths simultaneously, while fragmented evidence delays action until stock is low.

Q Is the maritime statistic your whole problem?
No. Ports and routes are one dependency class alongside suppliers, facilities, materials, owners, and regions.

Q How is this different from Cambridge link prediction?
Cambridge supports the technical plausibility of reconstruction. Substrata adds citations, confirmation, deterministic impact/runway, action governance, and audit.

Q Is link prediction already implemented elsewhere?
Research and commercial tools exist. We do not claim novelty in the algorithm; our thesis is the verifiable decision workflow around it.

Q How is this different from SAP or risk platforms?
We position it as a complementary, narrow experiment - not as proof that they lack multi-tier visibility or orchestration.

Q What value do users receive?
Earlier investigation, a decision deadline instead of a vague score, less false certainty, and a reviewable action record.

Q What is your business model?
Still a hypothesis: likely enterprise software or an add-on for risk/procurement teams. Buyer, pricing, and data-sharing must be validated.

Q Why SAP?
The workflow naturally consumes procurement, BOM, inventory, planning, supplier-network, and approval context.

Q Do you have live SAP access?
No. Current data is synthetic and SAP-shaped. Any SAP adapter remains read-only and subject to verified access.

Q Which SAP technologies fit?
S/4 APIs, Business Network/Ariba, BTP Integration Suite, HANA graph/vector, AI Core, and optional Joule/MCP/A2A adapters.

Q What is clean core here?
Use released APIs and side-by-side extension on BTP; do not modify the ERP core.

Q What if SAP services are unavailable?
The seeded local replay remains the core path; the pitch does not depend on internet or entitlement.

Q Why use the Nexperia case?
It is a public, understandable disruption context. The graph, inventory, lead times, and actions remain explicitly synthetic.

Q Is the 72-day result real?
No. It is the synthetic difference between assumed 90-day qualification and calculated 18-day cover.

Q What must be validated next?
Practitioner need, acceptable uncertainty, data access/licensing, reviewer burden, SAP entitlements, and measured held-out performance.

Q Why should this advance?
The proof is narrow, explainable, safe, and feasible: one link, one event, one deterministic result, one approval, one audit trail.

13. Judge Q&A - AI, math, safety, validation, and final recall

Q What is agentic?
Bounded roles interpret evidence, call tools, pause for confirmation, prepare options, and preserve state across human gates.

Q Why LangGraph?
It coordinates explicit state, tools, retries, pauses, and approvals. It does not perform graph math or validate relationships itself.

Q Why LangChain?
For grounded path-specific retrieval and cited answers that label known, inferred, and unknown information.

Q Do you train an LLM?
No custom LLM training or fine-tuning. Pretrained models sit behind a provider-neutral gateway.

Q What is Google Gen AI SDK?
The planned Google client adapter for Gemini access; Gemini is the model service, while the SDK is the integration library.

Q Can AI confirm a relationship?
No. AI can propose and explain a candidate; an authorized analyst or supplier confirms or rejects it.

Q Who calculates impact?
Deterministic NetworkX/PostgreSQL services perform traversal, units, exposure, runway, and policy checks.

Q What does the assistant cite?
Exact evidence passages and source metadata tied to the supply-chain path under investigation.

Q Can the system buy anything?
No. It produces dry-run SAP-shaped drafts; real procurement writes are prohibited.

Q How do you prevent hallucination?
Strict JSON, schema validation, exact evidence spans, status labels, bounded tools, and human review.

Q What if evidence conflicts?
Preserve both sources, keep the relationship inferred, show uncertainty, and request confirmation.

Q How is confidentiality handled?
Tenant isolation, access control, minimum excerpts, approved sources, signed expiring requests, and no sensitive logs.

Q Does audit prove truth?
No. It proves integrity of the recorded sequence, not correctness of the original evidence or decision.

Q Is accuracy proven?
No. Current measurements are synthetic regression evidence. Targets become claims only after versioned held-out runs.

Q What does 10/10 mean?
Ten identical seeded replays demonstrate reproducibility only, not prediction quality.

Q What if inputs are stale?
The action expires or returns for review; approval is bound to versions and deadlines.

Q What is the biggest product risk?
Poor evidence or too many false positives could create analyst distrust and review overload.

Q What is the final takeaway?
Substrata turns hidden uncertainty into cited evidence, quantified runway, and accountable human action.

Five numbers and labels to remember

18 days cover | 90 days qualification | 72 days exposure | targets: precision >= 0.80, recall >= 0.70 | 10/10 identical replay = reproducibility only. Always say synthetic, target, planned, optional, or access-dependent where applicable.

Sources: SAP Hackfest; SAP Learning Hub; SAP AI-agent guidance; SAP Supply Chain Orchestration; Cambridge Supply Chain AI Lab; ACEA Nexperia statement; UNCTAD maritime review; SAP Business Network multitier collaboration; SAP HANA property graph; SAP Clean Core; NIST AI 600-1. Full links are in README.md and docs/RESEARCH.md.